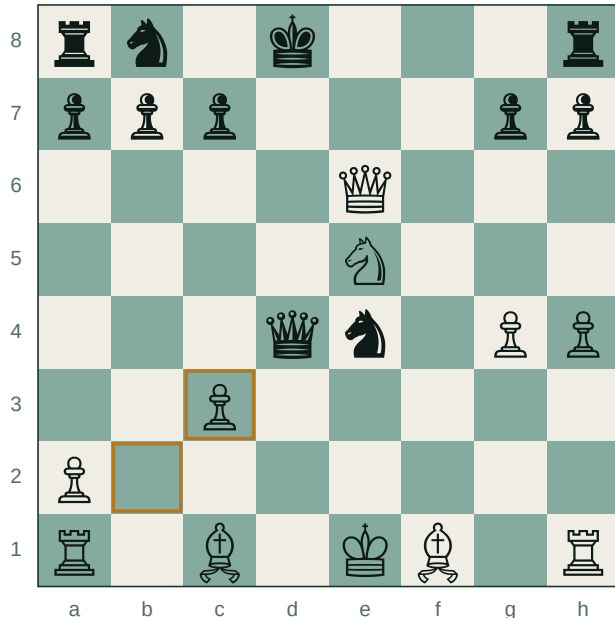


Intermediate moves: Black, move 15

Intermediate moves

Black to move



Previous move: 15.bxc3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

15...Qf2+ 16. Kd1 Nxc3#

15...Qf2+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. From f2 it attacks king on e1 and bishop on f1. Recorded reply: **16.Kd1**.

16...Nxc3# Mate: knight on c3 gives check; White has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on d1. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Knight on c3. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The postponed recapture may disappear. The intermediate move must win enough or preserve the right to recover material.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

An intermediate move interrupts an expected sequence with a stronger immediate threat. Instead of recapturing automatically, use a check or another forcing move to change the result.

HOW TO LOOK

Before every routine recapture, scan checks, queen attacks, and mating threats. Return to the original capture only if it still helps.

The defending king is on e1. Geometrically undefended: queen on e6 and rook on h1. Check for tactical protection.